PREMIUM COURSE MATERIAL

MODULE 3
LESSON 1

Reference Image Workflow

Learn the essentials of reference image workflow

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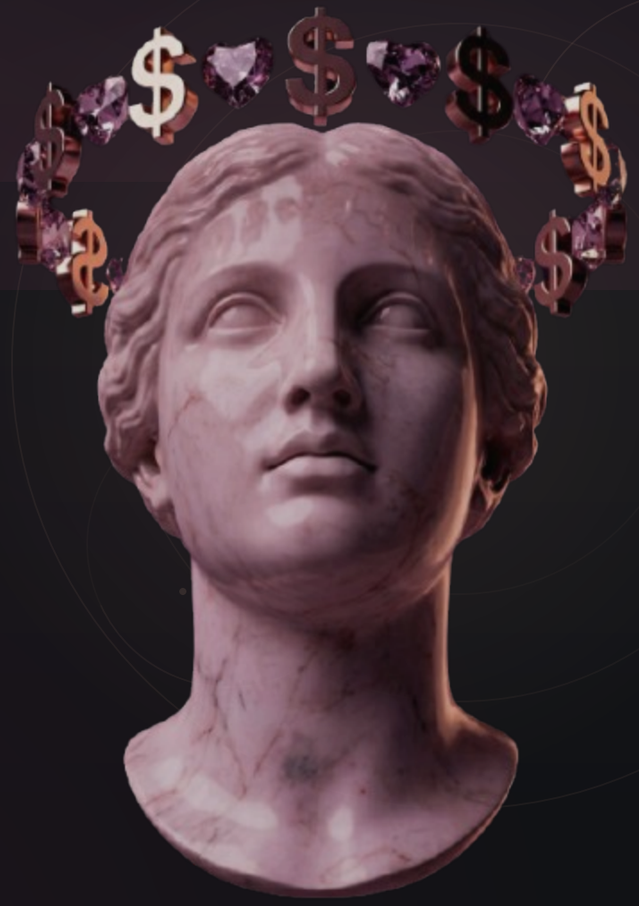

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LESSON 1: REFERENCE IMAGE WORKFLOW

The reference image workflow is the backbone of your content pipeline. Instead of writing prompts from scratch and hoping for good results, you find real photos that have the exact pose, lighting, and setting you want — then you recreate them with your AI model. This is how you produce content that looks like a real photoshoot, not random AI generations.

Nano Banana 2 is your main tool for all SFW image generation. The workflow is simple: find a reference image on Pinterest, generate a JSON prompt from it, then feed that JSON prompt into Nano Banana 2 along with your base model image. The output matches the reference image's pose and lighting — but with your AI model's face and body.

The Reference Workflow

- → Find a reference image on Pinterest with the pose, lighting, and setting you want
- → Generate a JSON prompt from that reference image
- → Feed the JSON prompt into Nano Banana 2 along with your base model image
- → Nano Banana 2 generates an image that copies the pose and lighting from the reference — but with your AI model
- → Generate at least 3 outputs and compare — pick the one that best matches your model's face
- → If the face drifts, regenerate — do not settle for inconsistent results

Finding Good Reference Images

- Pinterest is your main source — search for poses, outfits, and settings you want to recreate
- Look for images with clear lighting and simple backgrounds — these produce the best results
- Save references into categories (casual, glam, gym, selfie, etc.) so you always have ideas ready
- The better the reference image, the better your output — do not use blurry or cluttered photos

Common Mistakes in Reference Workflow

- Using blurry or low-quality reference images from Pinterest — find clean, well-lit photos
- Picking reference poses that are too complex — start with simple, natural poses
- Ignoring face drift on 'almost good enough' images — never post a drifted face
- Only generating one version — always generate at least 3 and pick the best
- Not saving your working JSON prompts — keep a library of prompts that produce good results

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END SUMMARY

- Always generate new images using your base model as a reference in Nano Banana 2
- Write detailed prompts with setting, lighting, outfit, and camera angle — save templates that produce good results
- Use Photopea (free) to export Instagram carousels — this helps avoid the AI filter on Instagram
- Always add approximately 2% grain/noise as the final editing step — this is what makes AI images pass as real photos
- Use the edit feature in Nano Banana 2 to fix specific problem areas without regenerating the entire image
- Know each platform's content rules — TikTok and Instagram are strictest, Reddit is most flexible
- When in doubt, keep it safe — a content strike can derail weeks of progress

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